Factory Assessment Report

Sustainable Compliance Initiative (SCI)

Companies that join the Fair Labor Association (FLA) agree to uphold the FLA Workplace Code of Conduct throughout their entire supply chain. The Code of Conduct is based on International Labour Organization (ILO) standards, and defines labor standards that aim to achieve decent and humane working conditions.

FLA member(s)	Fast Retailing Co., Ltd. - 25
Country	Bangladesh
Assessment Date	9/10/2025
Assessment Company	SCSA - 200008

Workforce Summary

Number of Workers	1402
Percentage female	42 %
Primary Languages	Bengali

Wage Data information

Monthly minimum wage in country at time of assessment	The legal monthly minimum wage in Bangladesh in 2024 is 12,500 BDT.
GLWC living wage benchmark for the country or relevant region at time of assessment	The GLWC living wage gross benchmark for Dhaka, Bangladesh in 2024 is 27,900 BDT. The GLWC living wage gross benchmark for Dhaka Satellite Cities in 2024 is 23,100 BDT.

Assessment Summary

Violations per FLA Code Element	Violated Benchmarks
Nondiscrimination (ND)	0
Health, Safety And Environment (HSE)	14
Employment Relationship (ER)	8
Hours Of Work (HOW)	4
Harassment Or Abuse (HA)	2
Freedom Of Association And Collective Bargaining (FOA)	0
Forced Labor (F)	0
Child Labor (CL)	0
Compensation (C)	3

Violations per Category	Violated Benchmarks
Immediate Action Required	18
Sustainable Improvement Required	13
Uncorroborated Risk of Non-Compliance	0
Notable Feature	0

Assessment Results

Compensation (C)	
Benchmark ID	C.1.1
Benchmark Details	Employers shall comply with all national laws, regulations and procedures concerning the payment of compensation to workers.
Finding Details	The factory has still not ensured to settle the group insurance payment to the nominee of the deceased worker, who died on November 25, 2024, due to not receiving the required papers from the nominee. In fact, the factory has yet to submit the claim to the respective authority for group insurance payment.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	Factory shall take necessary step to apply for group insurance compensation for deceased worker and handover group insurance compnesation to the nominee.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh Labor act 2006, chapter 8, section 99, sub-section 2: The amount claimed as insurance shall be in addition to the other dues of a worker under this Act: Provided that the recovery of the insurance claim due to death of a worker shall be the responsibility of the employer and he shall make arrangement for payment of the amount so recovered from such insurance claim directly to the dependents: Provided further that notwithstanding anything contrary contained in any other law, where any insurance claim is made under this section, it shall be settled by joint initiatives of the insurance company and the employer within 120 (one hundred and twenty) days from the date of raising such claim

Benchmark ID	C.25.2
Benchmark Details	Advances shall only be made following clearly established rules which have been communicated to workers.
Finding Details	The factory does not have a written policy and procedure on wage advances.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Sustainable improvement required
Local Law	

Benchmark ID	C.21.1
Benchmark Details	Employers shall provide all legally mandated benefits, including holidays, leave, bonuses, severance payments and 13th month payments to all eligible workers within legally defined time periods.
Finding Details	The factory sells food items at the canteen based on face value instead of purchase value.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	The factory shall ensure that food items are sold at the canteen based on their purchase value instead of face value.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Rules, 2015, chapter 8, section 89: 1) The foods, drinks and other materials supplied in the canteen shall be sold without gaining profits. The quality and price of the supplied food items shall be fixed and approved by the Management Committee.

Employment Relationship (ER)

Benchmark ID	ER.18.2
Benchmark Details	Employers shall ensure managers and supervisors are fully familiar with the workplace disciplinary system and in applying appropriate disciplinary practices.
Finding Details	It was noted that managers & supervisors are not fully familiar with workplace disciplinary system. 10 out of 15 managers & supervisors' awareness level on workplace disciplinary system were found undesirable. They were not well aware about the types of misconduct, disciplinary action process, inquiry process and punishment of disciplinary action.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Sustainable improvement required
Local Law	

Benchmark ID	ER.4

Benchmark Details	Employers shall inform workers about workplace rules, environmental protection systems, health and safety information, and laws regarding workers' rights with respect to freedom of association, compensation, working hours, and any other legally required information, and the FLA Code through appropriate means, including posted in local language(s) throughout the workplace's common areas.
Finding Details	The factory does not have regular communication to workers on all FLA's Code elements and Employment Functions.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Sustainable improvement required
Local Law	

Benchmark ID	ER.8
Benchmark Details	Employers shall have written policies and procedures with regard to promotion, demotion, and job reassignment that outline the criteria, demonstrate linkages to job grading, and prohibit discrimination or use of demotion or job reassignment as a form of penalty or punishment, are provided in writing and seek feedback from employees in writing, and follow all local legal requirements.
Finding Details	The factory does not have a written policy and procedure on demotion and job reassignment.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Sustainable improvement required
Local Law	

Benchmark ID	ER.19.1
Benchmark Details	Employers shall maintain on file all documentation needed to demonstrate compliance with the FLA Workplace Code and required laws.

Finding Details	(1) It was noted that the factory has installed solar panels at the roof top of the main production building but the factory did not update machine layout plan and gain approval from the concerned authority. (2) It was noted that pictures for worker's identification card needed to be provided by workers instead of taken by the factory. In addition, it is a mandatory requirement to bring blood group test report of newly joining workers before joining the factory.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	(1) Factory shall update the machine layout plan and shall obtain an approval plan from the department. (2) Factory shall arrange a picture for workers' identification and shall avoid asking new joining employees to bring a blood group test report.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with BNBC 2020; part-2, chapter-3, section 3.1: No building or structure regulated by this Code shall be erected, constructed, enlarged, altered, repaired, moved, improved, removed, converted or demolished without obtaining permit for each such work from the building official. In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Rules 2015, Section: 353, Sub-Section: 1- Before use, change or expansion of any houses, building or premises as factory, approval in writing of the inspector general or any officer empowered by him shall be taken. In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Rules, 2015 chapter 1, section 19, sub section 5 (amendment 2022): Every owner shall provide identity card with photo as per form 6 to every worker employed in his establishment at owner's expense and shall provide said identity card and employment letter in Bengali. Provided, however, that if necessary, the identity card and appointment letter shall be provided in English long with Bengali language.

Benchmark ID	ER.6.1
Benchmark Details	Employers shall have written policies and procedures and implement practices that encourage ongoing training of all categories of workers with the goal of raising or broadening skills in order to advance in their careers within the factory or beyond.
Finding Details	It was noted that the factory did not establish a written procedure on personnel development that encourages ongoing training with the goal of raising or broadening workers' skills so they can advance in their careers.

Recommendations for Immediate Action	
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Sustainable improvement required
Local Law	

Benchmark ID	ER.5.1
Benchmark Details	Employers shall ensure that all supervisors are trained in national laws, workplace regulations, and the FLA Code, workplace grievance systems, and the appropriate practices to ensure compliance.
Finding Details	It was noted that the factory did not provide any specific training to the relevant supervisors that includes all FLA's Code elements and Employment Functions.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Sustainable improvement required
Local Law	

Benchmark ID	ER.7.1
Benchmark Details	Employers shall have written policies and procedures with regard to performance reviews that outline the review steps and process, demonstrate linkages to job grading, prohibit discrimination, are provided in writing and seek feedback and agreement/disagreement from employees in writing, and that follow all local legal requirements.
Finding Details	It was noted that the factory does not conduct performance evaluations for all workers. The factory conducted performance evaluation only when promoting workers from their existing position to a higher position, but workers do not have any option to provide their feedback regarding their performance review results.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Sustainable improvement required

Local Law	

Benchmark ID	ER.1.2
Benchmark Details	Employers shall assign responsibility for the administration of human resources to a clearly defined and adequately qualified staff member or staff members and ensure workers at all levels receive communication and training about existing policies and procedures or any revisions.
Finding Details	It was noted that the factory did not provide ongoing training to workers on FLA's Code elements and Employment Functions.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Sustainable improvement required
Local Law	

Harassment Or Abuse (H/A)

Benchmark ID	H/A.10.1.2
Benchmark Details	Body searches and physical pat downs shall only be undertaken when there is a specific, legitimate reason to do so and upon consent of workers, unless a state official with the power to do so (e.g. police officer) has ordered the search.
Finding Details	It was noted that the factory conducts body searches of workers, on a routine basis, but does not obtain any consent from the workers.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Sustainable improvement required
Local Law	

Benchmark ID	H/A.10.1.3
Benchmark Details	Body searches shall not be undertaken in public and the person who undertakes the search shall be of the same sex as the person who is being searched.
Finding Details	It was noted that body searches of male workers were conducted in front of the exit and entrance gates of the factory building without ensuring proper privacy.

Recommendations for Immediate Action	
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Sustainable improvement required
Local Law	

Health, Safety And Environment (HSE)

Benchmark ID	HSE.14.1
Benchmark Details	All production machinery, equipment and tools shall be properly guarded and regularly maintained.
Finding Details	(1) It was noted that the construction of building number 2 has not yet been completed with proper clearance. However, the basement floor was used as the workers' dining hall, canteen, stationery store, yarn store, and machine store and ground floor & 1st floor were used by sister factory Pretty Composite Textile Ltd for washing process. No lightning protection system is in place to protect the building from the negative impacts of thundering. (2) It was noted that there is no speed limit for vehicles posted inside of the factory; (3) It was noted that the traffic lane and walk paths were not clearly marked in front of entrance & exit gates and inside of the factory premises where vehicle move; (4) It was noted that there were two moving ladders found at the finished goods warehouse and yarn warehouse without break or locking systems on the wheels which may cause an accident.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	(1) Factory shall install lightning protection system at all required areas and ensure the buildings are safe before allowing they are used; (2) Factory shall post speed limits of the vehicles in the factory; (3) Factory shall mark traffic lane and walk path clearly; (4) Factory shall ensure the ladders have breaks or locking systems on the wheels installed to prevent the accident.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh National Building Code 2020, Part 3, chapter 1, section 1.24 In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Rules, 2015, chapter 6, section 67, sub-section 1 In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Law 2006, Chapter- 6, Section – 62, Sub section-4

Benchmark ID	HSE.5.1
Benchmark Details	All applicable, legally required or recommended elements of safe evacuation shall be complied with, including all of the following elements: posting evacuation plans; the installation and maintenance of fire alarms; the installation and maintenance of emergency lighting; ensuring aisles/exits are not blocked and that workers are not blocked within their workstations; employee education and training; and evacuation procedures and fire drills.
Finding Details	(1) The factory does not prohibit smoking within 50 feet (15 meters) of the building premise, entrance & exit gate, waste storage area, chemical storage area, utility area and operable windows and all closed areas. (2) There is an inwardly open type of exit door provided at one out of two exits of the sample section where more than 20 people were working in this area. (3) There is no exit directional floor marking or exit directional sign provided for at least four passageways at the finished goods warehouse and six passageways of the jacquard knitting section to show the direction of main exit for easy evacuation in case of any emergency. In addition, one aisle floor marking at the packing section and three aisle floor markings at the linking section were faded.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	(1) Factory shall prohibit smoking within 15 meters of the factory premises. (2) Factory shall provide the outwardly open exit door at all required areas. (3) Factory shall provide exit directional floor markings or exit directional signs at all required passage ways. Regular repainting shall be carried out.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required

Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Rules, 2015, chapter 6, section 66: There has to be prohibition of smoking and usage of the source of ignition (such as- candle, match, gas lighter etc.) in hazardous places or in places where the Inspector thinks fit. In addition, the concerned institute must write and notify precautionary statements in easily understandable Bengali language in noticeable places in cases where the possibility of fire accidents is high. In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Law 2006, chapter 6, section 62, sub-section 3 (2) amendment 2013: The door shall be constructed such way that immediately opened from inside while any person is in the room and it should be outward open. In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Law 2006, Chapter- 6, Section – 62, Sub section-4: In every factory every window, door, or other exit affording means of escape in case of fire, other than the means of exit in ordinary use, shall be distinctively marked in a language understood by the majority of the workers and in red letters of adequate size or by some other effective and clearly understood sign.

Benchmark ID	HSE.28
Benchmark Details	Employers shall create a system to ensure that all necessary Health and Safety protections are provided for external contractors; including protection when working within , confined spaces, maintenance issues, and general Health and Safety Issues.
Finding Details	The factory did not provide safety information to contractors.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Sustainable improvement required
Local Law	

Benchmark ID	HSE.5.1.4
Benchmark Details	All applicable, legally required or recommended elements of safe evacuation shall be complied with, including all the following: ensuring aisles/exits are not blocked and that workers are not blocked within their workstations
Finding Details	Workers' evacuation passage routes were partially obstructed by goods, equipment, co-workers, and workstations, such as in the linking section, knitting section, sewing section, and ironing section. In addition, two aisles of the winding section and one aisle of the finished goods warehouse were partially obstructed by goods and a trolley.

Recommendations for Immediate Action	Factory shall ensure obstacle obstacle-free aisles and passageways for easy evacuation in case of any emergency.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Law 2006, Chapter- 6, Section – 62, sub- section 6, a free passage-way giving access to each means of escape in case of fire shall be maintained for the use of all workers in every room of the factory.

Benchmark ID	HSE.5.1.6
Benchmark Details	All applicable, legally required or recommended elements of safe evacuation shall be complied with, including all the following elements: evacuation procedures and fire drills
Finding Details	The factory conducts fire evacuation drills on a regular basis, but there is no assessment conducted after the drill to learn how to improve the evacuation process.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Sustainable improvement required
Local Law	

Benchmark ID	HSE.9.1
Benchmark Details	All chemicals and hazardous substances shall be properly labeled and stored in secure and ventilated areas and disposed of in a safe and legal manner, in accordance with applicable laws and international standards.
Finding Details	(1) The factory did not post safety labels for some chemicals (such as acetone, thinner, WD 40, contact cleaner) as per Globally Harmonized System. In addition, some safety labels posted were in the English language instead of the native language. Some chemicals safety labels were found mismatch with original safety label of chemicals provided by supplier. (2) There is no 'no smoking' sign posted at the chemical store. In addition, there is no locking system provided or any register to control unauthorized access at the chemical store. (3) It was noted that there is no secondary containment provided for chemicals at the general store. In addition, the factory ensures to provide at least 110% capacity of secondary containment for the chemical containers such as in the spot removing room and chemical store.

Recommendations for Immediate Action	1/ Factory shall ensure safety labels of chemicals are available as per Globally Harmonized System. 2/ Factory shall post a no-smoking sign at the chemical store and shall provide locking system or maintain register book to control unauthorized access at the chemical store. 3/ Factory shall ensure provide proper size & capacity of secondary containment is provided for the chemicals.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Law 2006, Chapter- 5, Section – 53: in every factory in which, by reason of the manufacturing process carried on, there is given off any dust or fume or other impurity of such a nature and to such an extent as is likely to be injurious or offensive to the workers employed therein. Effective measures shall be taken to prevent it's accumulation in any work-room and its inhalation by workers.

Benchmark ID	HSE.17.1
Benchmark Details	Workstations, including seating and standing arrangements and reach required to obtain tools, shall be designed and set-up in such a manner as to minimize bodily strains.
Finding Details	There are no anti-fatigue mats provided for at least 10% of long-standing workers in the quality inspection section.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	The factory shall provide anti-fatigue mats for the long-standing workers.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Rules, 2015, chapter 6, section 67: (1) Safety measures and health safety must be arranged in accordance with the directions of this Rule or the regulations of the concerned govt. department for the workers who are employed in the procedures of manufacturing processes that have high risks of physical injury or loss. 2) In addition to the arrangement of safety and health protection measures mentioned in Sub-section (1), the concerned manufacturing institute must provide necessary equipment's, including safety shoes, helmets, goggles, masks, hand gloves, ear muffs, ear plugs, waist belts, aprons etc. and arrange training programs for the workers in using these materials and ensure their usage.

Benchmark ID	HSE.1
Benchmark Details	Employers shall comply with all national laws, regulations and procedures concerning health, safety, and the environment.
Finding Details	(1) Different types of waste material (metal scrap, cardboard, chemical containers) stored beside wastage storage room & roof top and are directly exposed to rainwater. (2) The factory did not separate hazardous and non-hazardous waste and provide proper labeling. Different types of hazardous and non-hazardous waste materials (metal scrap, cardboard, electrical waste, paper waste, wood etc.) stored together, such as at the exhaust gas boiler room and beside the waste storage room. (3) The factory has made a waste disposal agreement, which has obtained a trade license for the purchase and selling of waste, but not for the disposal of waste. In addition, this enterprise did not obtain the environmental clearance certificate from the concerned department. Besides, the factory has made an ETP sludge disposal agreement with another company, whose environmental clearance certificate expired in March 22, 2025. The facility has applied for renewal on May 14, 2025, but has yet to obtain a renewal copy of the environmental clearance certificate. (4) It was noted that the factory did not ensure to properly treat its wastewater before releasing it into the environment. Based on the latest wastewater test report, which was conducted on February 10, 2025, the color parameter of wastewater exceeded the Bangladesh Standard for wastewater. As per the Bangladesh Standard, the color level should be 150, but the test report found 993, which exceeded the Bangladesh Standard as per the Bangladesh Environmental Conservation Rules 2023. (5) (i) It was noted that the environmental clearance certificate for the washing process expired on September 1, 2025. The factory has applied for renewal on September 3, 2025. In
Recommendations for Immediate Action	(1) Factory shall store waste material in a proper manner and disposal by a government approved organization. (2) Factory shall store hazardous and non-hazardous waste separately and ensure proper labelling. (3) Factory shall make waste disposal agreement with a government approved organization. (4) Factory shall treat waste water properly before release to the environment and shall ensure all parameters of waste water comply with legal requirement. (5) Factory shall obtain a renewal copy of environmental clearance certificate from the concerned department and shall ensure to maintain safety checklists by safety committee, at least quarterly.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	

Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Rules, 2015, chapter 5, section 40. In accordance with Bangladesh Environmental conservation rules 2023 In accordance with Bangladesh Environmental Conservational Act 1995, amendment 2010, section 12 (1) In accordance with Environment Conservation Rules 2023, Schedule 1 In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Rules 2015, schedule 4, section 4, sub-section B

Benchmark ID	HSE.4.1
Benchmark Details	Employers shall at all times be in possession of all legally required and valid permits and certificates related to health, safety, and environmental issues, such as: Purchase and storage of chemicals; Fire safety inspections; Machinery inspections; Waste disposal; Environmental licenses/permits;Sanitation permits, including those required for canteens; and Vehicle inspection and driver permits for all employer provided transportation.
Finding Details	(1) Generator permission is expired on October 29, 2024. The factory had applied for renewal on October 10, 2024 but has yet to obtain the renewal copy of generator permission from the concerned department. (2) The factory has a total of five compressors, however, the factory did not conduct a hydraulic test of compressor vessel by the competent personnel or organization.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	(1) Factory shall take the necessary steps to obtain a renewal copy of the generator operating permission. (2) Factory shall conduct hydraulic tests for compressor vessels by engaging competent personnel or an organization.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required

Local Law	In accordance with the Bangladesh Energy Regulatory Commission Act, 2003, Sec 27: (1) of Bangladesh: No person shall engage himself in the following business unless he is empowered by a license or exempted from having it under this Act or any other Act, such as:- power generation; energy transmission; energy distribution and marketing; energy supply; and energy storage. In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Rules 2015, chapter 6, section 62, sub-section 1(GHA) – Following test should be done by the competent personnel: (A) For ensure the general condition of the vessel and the effectiveness of its fittings, external part should be tested once in every six months; (B) Should be tested once in a year inner side, inside of vessel and outside wall, effectiveness of the seams and spares parts of vessel and the fault of seroson. But, provided that, if it is not possible to check the inner part for the vessel due to construction problem, in that case Hydraulic test should be done once in every two years.

Benchmark ID	HSE.6.1
Benchmark Details	All safety and medical equipment (e.g. fire fighting equipment, first aid kits) shall be available in sufficient numbers throughout the workplace, maintained and stocked as prescribed, and easily accessible to workers.
Finding Details	There is no floor markings or non-obstacle signs provided for at least 25 fire extinguishers, such as in the boiler room, generator room, compressor room, ETP control panel room, chemical store, waste storage area, dining hall, yarn store, and production floor.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	Factory shall provide floor markings or non-obstacle signs under all firefighting equipment.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh National Building Code 2020, part 4, chapter 4, section 4.4, sub-section 4.4.3: Portable fire extinguishers shall be fully charged, operable at any time and conspicuously located where they will be readily accessible. Portable fire extinguishers shall not be obstructed or obscured from view. In large rooms, means shall be provided to indicate the extinguisher location

Benchmark ID	HSE.8

Benchmark Details	Workers shall be provided with training on the use and maintenance of personal protective equipment. Training shall be upon hire with periodic refresher training offered to all workers. Management will ensure use of PPE as necessary.
Finding Details	(1) The factory did not provide PPE training to all employees. The factory has a total of 1650 employees but last year only 441 employees received training on PPE. The last batch of training provided on September 2, 2025 the total number of participants was only 39. (2) It was noted that at least 15% of workers were working without wearing face masks, such as workers at the jacquard knitting section, linking section, ironing section, winding section, washing section, and mending section. (3) In addition, boiler operators were working without wearing ear plugs under the high noise environment and at least 10% of long-standing workers were working without using anti-fatigue mats.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	(1) Factory shall increase trainings on PPE and ensure all workers are participating in the training. (2) Factory shall enhance the awareness of workers to wear PPE with effective manner to ensure their own safety. In addition, anti-fatigue mats are to be provided to the long-standing workers.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Act 2006, chapter 7, section 78A: (3) Every worker shall be made aware of the hazards of work through training in order to ensure the protection and safety of his professional health in the place of work. In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Rules, 2015, chapter 5, section 46, sub section 2: The workers engaged in such places with dust and fume should wear mask. In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Act 2006, chapter 7, section 78A: (1) No authority shall engage any worker in work without providing him with personal safety equipment's and ensuring uses thereof and a record book shall be maintained in this behalf by the employer in the prescribed manner. (2) If any personal safety equipment is supplied but not used, the worker concerned shall be liable. (3) Every worker shall be made aware of the hazards of work through training in order to ensure the protection and safety of his professional health in the place of work

Benchmark ID	HSE.17.2

Benchmark Details	Employers shall train workers in proper lifting techniques, and items such as lifting belts shall be provided.
Finding Details	The factory did not provide training to workers on ergonomics and lifting techniques.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	The factory shall provide training to workers on ergonomics and lifting techniques.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Act 2006, chapter 7, section 78A: (3) Every worker shall be made aware of the hazards of work through training in order to ensure the protection and safety of his professional health in the place of work.

Benchmark ID	HSE.14.2
Benchmark Details	Workers shall receive training in the proper use and safe operation of machinery, equipment and tools they use.
Finding Details	It was noted that the factory did not ensure training is provided to all relevant workers on operating machinery and vehicles. The factory has a total of 1650 employees, but in the last year, only 30 employees received training on operating machines. The last training was provided on July 19, 2025, and the total participants were only 5 workers.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	The factory shall provide training to all workers on operating machines.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Act 2006, chapter 7, section 78A: (3) Every worker shall be made aware of the hazards of work through training in order to ensure the protection and safety of his professional health in the place of work.

Benchmark ID	HSE.14.3
Benchmark Details	Employers shall ensure safety instructions are either displayed or posted near all machinery or are readily accessible to the workers in language(s) spoken by workers.
Finding Details	It was noted that there are no safety instructions displayed in local language on the machines, such as jacquard knitting machine, ETP blower machine, washing machine, boiler, generator, compressor etc. The factory have only posted safety instruction or warning sign in English & Chinese language.

Recommendations for Immediate Action	The factory shall display/post safety instructions of machines in the local language.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Rules, 2015, chapter 6, section 67: (1) Safety measures and health safety must be arranged in accordance with the directions of this Rule or the regulations of the concerned govt. department for the workers who are employed in the procedures of manufacturing processes that have high risks of physical injury or loss.

Hours Of Work (HOW)

Benchmark ID	HOW.21
Benchmark Details	Other than in exceptional circumstances, the total weekly work hours (regular work hours plus overtime including any alternative shifts such as 4x4 or 3x3) shall not exceed 60 hours per week.

Finding Details	Initially, the factory provided wage records and time cards which captured regular hours plus maximum 4 hours overtime and reported that daily maximum overtime duty at 4 hours & no rest day work was arranged for workers, except for a special arrangement for providing additional holiday with EID festival. However, the audit gathered records of overtime duty after 4 hours & rest day and communicated this with the factory management to ensure transparency. Factory management subsequently submitted the actual wage and time cards. Based on 2nd set of time cards from September 2024 to August 2025 it was noted that daily overtime of workers ranged from 2 to maximum 15 hours and weekly working hours exceed 60 hours to maximum 96 hours for at least 70% of sampling workers such as: (i) August 18 to 24, 2025 total 83.5 hours a week & daily maximum overtime hours was 10, August 23 to 29, 2025 total 96 hours a week & daily maximum overtime hours was 8, July 14 to 20, 2025 total 88 hours a week & daily maximum overtime hours was 13, June 21 to 27, 2025 total 74 hours a week & daily maximum overtime hours was 8 and June 19 to 25, 2025 total 91 hours a week and daily maximum overtime hours was 13. (ii) May 17 to 23, 2025 total 94 hours a week & daily maximum overtime hours was 13, May 17 to 23, 2025 total 74 hours a week & daily maximum overtime hour was 8, April 21 to 27, 2025 total 93.5 hours a week & daily maximum overtime hours was 13 and March 17 to 23, 2025 total 93 hours a week & daily maximum overtime hours was 13. (iii) February 16 to 22, 2025 total 90 hours & daily maximum overtime hours was 14, January 11 to 16, 2025 total 84.5 hours & daily maximum overtime hours was 8 and December 21 to
Recommendations for Immediate Action	The factory shall take necessary steps to reduce excessive working hours and comply with legal requirements and FLA Code. The weekly working hours shall not exceed 60 hours.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required

Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Law, 2006, Chapter-9, Section-102: (1) The total hours of work of an adult worker shall not exceed sixty hours in any week and on the average fifty-six hours per week in any year. (2) Subject to the provisions of section 108, an adult worker may work for more than 48 (forty-eight) hours also in a week: Provided that the total working hours of such worker shall not exceed 60 (sixty) hours in a week, and on the average 56 (fifty-six) hours per week in a year: Provided further that the total additional working hours of a worker employed in a road transport establishment shall not exceed 150 (one hundred and fifty) hours in a year: Provided further that the Government may, in the cases of some particular industries, under conditions imposed by order in writing, relax the provisions of this section or exempt from the provisions of this section at a time for a period of not exceeding 6 (six) months, if it is satisfied that in the public interest or in the interest of economic development such relaxation or exemption is necessary.

Benchmark ID	HOW.3
Benchmark Details	Employers shall provide reasonable meal and rest breaks, which, at a minimum, must comply with national laws.
Finding Details	It was noted that the facility provided a one-hour break instead of two hours for those who worked in hazardous positions, such as the boiler operator, electrician, generator operator, and compressor operator.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	The factory shall ensure to provide at least 15 minutes break per hour (2 hours for an 8-hour shift) for the workers who are working with a hazardous type of work.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Rules 2015, Chapter-9, Section-99, sub-section 2, amendment 2022: The workers who are employed in construction, re-rolling, steel mills, ship breaking industry and hazardous works mentioned in Section/Rule 68 cannot be made to work again without giving them 15 minutes break after every hours of work alternately. However, in order to materialize the purposes mentioned in Section 101 (d), the Owner cannot deduct the wages of the workers for giving this type of rest.

Benchmark ID	HOW.2

Benchmark Details	Workers shall be entitled to at least 24 consecutive hours of rest in every seven- day period. If workers must work on a rest day, an alternative consecutive 24 hours must be provided within that same seven-day period or immediately following.
Finding Details	It was noted that the factory did not ensure that workers received at least 24 hours of consecutive rest after six consecutive working days to workers. At least 60% of sampling workers did not get at least one day off after six consecutive working days, and maximum consecutive working days found at 47 days, such as: (i) August 6 to 31, 2025 total consecutive working day 26 days, July 7 to 26, 2025 total consecutive working day 20 days and June 16 to 28, 2025 total consecutive working day 13 days. (ii) May 10 to 22, 2025 total consecutive working day 13 days, May 13 to June 4, 2025 total consecutive working day 23 days, April 15 to 30, 2025 total consecutive working day 16 days and February 22 to March 28, 2025 total consecutive working day 35 days. (iii) January 6 to February 14, 2025 total consecutive working day 41 days, January 6 to 25, 2025 total consecutive working day 20 days, December 17 to 31, 2024 total consecutive working day 14 days. (iv) November 12 to December 14, 2024 total consecutive working day 33 days, October 12 to November 28, 2024 total consecutive working day 47 days and September 17 to October 5, 2024 total consecutive working day 19 days.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	The factory shall ensure to provide at least one day off after six consecutive working days.
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Immediate Action Required
Local Law	In accordance with Bangladesh Labor Law 2006, Chapter 9, section 103: Every worker employed in an establishment (a) shall be entitled to 1 (one and a half) day holiday in a week in the case of a shop or commercial establishment or an industrial, establishment and 1 (one) day in a week in the case of a factory and establishment.

Benchmark ID	HOW.9.2
Benchmark Details	Employers shall take reasonable steps to inform workers about the nature and expected duration of the circumstances sufficiently in advance to allow workers to make alternative plans.

Finding Details	It was noted that the facility did not receive worker consent before overtime duty and did not notify workers about overtime duty at the beginning of the shift. Based on the factory management statement, the factory generally informed workers about overtime duty after lunch hour verbally through PA system.
Recommendations for Immediate Action	
Recommendations for Sustainable Improvement	
Compliance Classifications	Sustainable improvement required
Local Law	